

Bob Tianqi Wei

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Education

Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Media Laboratory	Aug 2026 – Expected May 2028
M.S. in Human-Computer Interaction	Advisor: Prof. Hiroshi Ishii
University of California at Berkeley, College of Engineering	Aug 2023 – Dec 2024
M.Des. in Human-Computer Interaction	Distinguished Scholar, 3.66/4
Tsinghua University, Academy of Arts and Design	Aug 2019 – Jun 2023
B.A. in Industrial Design	3.71/4

Publications

- MorphingSkin: A Skin-like Platform that Integrates Multimodal Hydraulic Actuators Based on Flexible Electroosmotic Pumps.** Tianyu Yu, Peisheng He, **Bob Tianqi Wei**, Chenyuheng Wang, Xueqing Li, Xuezhu Wang, Yao Lu, Wei Yue, Megan Teng, Zihan Wang, Liwei Lin, Haipeng Mi, Qi Lu, Lining Yao.
ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology (UIST) 2025, 🏆 BEST PAPER AWARD. 10.1145/3746059.3747685
- Labor, Power, and Belonging: The Work of Voice in the Age of AI Reproduction.** Shm Almeda, Robin Netzorg, Isabel Li, Ethan Tam, Skyla Ma, **Bob Tianqi Wei**.
ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT) 2025. 10.1145/3715275.3732082
- Generating Visual Aids to Help Students Understand Graphic Design with EKPHRASIS.** **Bob Tianqi Wei**, Shayne Shen, Shm Almeda, Bjoern Hartmann.
ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI) 2025. 10.1145/3706599.3719807
- Sympathetic Orchestra: A Responsive Virtual Orchestra for Embodied Interpretive Practice in Conducting.** **Bob Tianqi Wei**, Shm Almeda, Shayne Shen, Ethan Tam, Dor Abrahamson.
ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI) 2026. 10.1145/3772363.3798418
- Demonstration of Sympathetic Orchestra: An Interactive Conducting Education System for Responsive, Tacit Skill Development.** **Bob Tianqi Wei**, Shm Almeda, Ethan Tam, Dor Abrahamson.
ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology (UIST) 2024. 10.1145/3672539.3686783

Experience

- UC Berkeley EECS - Berkeley Institute of Design Lab. Prof. Bjoern Hartmann**, Research Assistant Nov 2023 – Jan 2026
- HCI research at the intersection of generative AI and creative work; mixed-methods integrated with system building
 - Developed [ArtiFactor](#), a multi-agent creative platform with LLMs and multimodal ML; full-stack orchestration (React/Node/Flask, Dockerized ML)
 - Co-authored *EKPHRASIS* (CHI '25) and *Labor, Power, and Belonging* (FAccT '25)
- eTopus Technology Inc.**, Software Engineer, San Jose, CA Oct 2025 – Jun 2026
- Built OpSyn, an internal multi-agent enterprise AI assistant using a DeepSeek-distilled LLM, Claude, and a Flask backend
 - Implemented React/Vite chat UI with streaming responses, file uploads, and Azure-authenticated user sessions
 - Integrated vector search and retrieval-augmented generation over SharePoint and Jira data for operational workflows
 - Designed explanation UIs that visualize agent tool-calls and support user trust in enterprise AI decisions
- Anything (Create, Inc.)**, Frontend Engineer (Contract), San Francisco, CA Jul 2025 – Sep 2025
- Shipped high-fidelity marketing sites for the [Anything](#) AI app builder; collaborated with design and founding team
 - Converted Figma specs into pixel-accurate, responsive React UI; established reusable components and design tokens
 - Contributed to internal AI-agent workflows and QA; improved UI quality and handoff with engineering
- UC Berkeley ME - Morphing Matter Lab. Prof. Lining Yao**, Researcher Feb 2025 – May 2025
- Co-designed a portable driver; contributed to schematic and PCB layout, isolation design, connector interfaces, and board bring-up for multimodal hydraulic actuation
 - Led structural stack-up and enclosure design; established repeatable fabrication workflows and assembly fixtures
 - Authored the *Design Space* and *Applications* sections; proposed and prototyped multiple application scenarios
 - Produced demo assets—storyboarded, filmed, and edited videos; prepared figures and documentation
 - Co-authored *MorphingSkin* (UIST '25 Best Paper)
- UC Berkeley School of Education. Prof. Dor Abrahamson**, Graduate Student Researcher Aug 2023 – Dec 2023
- Investigated embodied learning and tacit skill acquisition in interactive educational environments
 - Developed *Sympathetic Orchestra* (UIST '24), a webcam-gesture + Web Audio system for responsive virtual-orchestra practice
- Tsinghua University, Dept. of Industrial Design. Prof. Lintao Tang**, Student Researcher Nov 2022 – Jul 2023

- Built **ILLUMINATIO**, an adaptive, AI-driven ambient lighting system responsive to user behavior (Raspberry Pi, Python/C++)
 - Synthesized illumination design principles from 18 technical publications to guide control parameters and evaluation
- Association for Computing Machinery (ACM)**, Reviewer Sep 2024 – Present
- Reviewed submissions for the ACM CHI conference, focusing on CSTs and education

Teaching

BPC Art Studio, AI Art and Creative Coding Courses , Instructor, Palo Alto, CA	Fall 2025
UC Berkeley, INFO 213: Introduction to User Experience Design , TA	Fall 2024
• Graded and provided feedback on assignments and coached students practice in-depth interviews and UX research.	
UC Berkeley, DESINV 22: Prototyping and Fabrication , Lead TA	Summer 2024
• Taught manufacturing techniques and basic electronics to help students build a Bluetooth-controlled vehicle.	
UC Berkeley, INFO C262: Theory and Practice of Tangible User Interfaces , Lead TA	Fall 2023
• Delivered introductory courses on open-source hardware development and programming.	
• Developed a course website enabling students to submit assignments, access course materials, schedule office hours.	
Tsinghua University, Romantic and 20th Century Piano Pieces Performance , Lead TA	Fall 2021, Spring 2022
Xiaozhe Art Studio and Wufang Design Studio, Graphic Design Courses , Instructor (Part Time)	Aug 2019 - Feb 2021

Presentations and Speeches

ACM UIST '25 , Busan, South Korea. <i>MorphingSkin</i> , Best Paper, demo & paper	Oct 2025
ACM FAccT '25 , Athens, Greece. <i>Labor, Power, and Belonging</i> , paper	Jun 2025
ACM CHI '25 , Yokohama, Japan. <i>Generating Visual Aids with EKPHRASIS</i> , paper & poster	Apr 2025
UC Berkeley MDes Graduation Ceremony . <i>The Transformative Power of Interdisciplinary Design</i> , invited speech	Dec 2024
UC Berkeley MDes Graduate Exhibition . <i>EKPHRASIS: Learning Tacit Knowledge in Visual Design</i> , demo	Dec 2024
Jacobs Winter Showcase (HCI) , UC Berkeley. <i>Romantic Breakups as a Lens for Industrial Cybersecurity</i> , poster	Dec 2024
ACM UIST '24 , Pittsburgh, PA, USA. <i>Sympathetic Orchestra</i> , demo	Oct 2024
UC Berkeley Education Research Day . <i>Building Professional Hearing</i> , paper	Apr 2024
Jacobs Design Showcase , UC Berkeley. <i>Poetry in Motion</i> , installation; <i>Plano</i> , installation	Dec 2023
ISAM '23 , Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, PA. <i>ILLUMINATIO</i> , poster	Oct 2023
Undergraduate Exhibition, Academy of Arts and Design, Tsinghua University . <i>Intelligent Illuminating Product Design Based on Machine Learning</i> , demo & paper	Jun 2023
Student Academic Exhibition, Tsinghua University . <i>Sympathetic Orchestra</i> , demo & poster	Apr 2023

Awards

Best Paper Award , ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology (UIST) 2025	Oct 2025
MDes Distinguished Scholar Award , University of California, Berkeley	Mar 2023
Social Work Excellence Scholarship , Tsinghua University	2020, 2023
Scholarship for Excellence in Literature and Art , Tsinghua University	2020, 2021, 2022
Honorable Mention , 3rd China College Student Power Battery Innovation Competition	Nov 2021
First Prize of Youth Group , The 7th Macau-Asia Pacific Youth Piano Competition	Jul 2021
Second Prize of Tsinghua University , Beijing College Students Engineering Ability Competition	Dec 2019

Music Performance

Bob Tianqi Wei: Stringed Harmony , Live at CNMAT, UC Berkeley	May 2024
Tianqi Wei & Friends' Graduation Concert , Live at Tsinghua University Music Library	May 2023
Rachmaninoff: Piano Concerto No.2 , Conductor, Live at New Tsinghua School Concert Hall	May 2022
Elisabeth (musical, Japanese) , Rudolf, Live at Meng Minwei Hall, Tsinghua University	Oct 2021
J.S.Bach: Concerto in D Minor BWV 974, Piano Solo , Live at Steinway Hall Beijing	Jul 2021
J.S.Bach: Goldberg Variations BWV 988, Piano Solo , Live at Meng Minwei Concert Hall	Dec 2020

Leadership

Tsinghua University Student Art Troupe Clavier Team , President	Aug 2021 - Aug 2022
• Organized and held large-scale concert activities and art popularization lectures.	
• Empowered the team to participate in international professional competitions.	
Tsinghua University iOS Club , Leader of Publicity Group and Member of Product Manager Team	Aug 2021 - Aug 2022
• Represented the club to Apple headquarters for an interaction and hardware theme exchange, allowing the club to receive support for development equipment, funding, and internship resources.	
• Led team developed a cognitive training app for the elderly to help them practice mental exercises to prevent dementia.	

- Organized basketball games and planned a promotional campaign for graduation music festivals.

Skills

Programming: Python, TypeScript/JavaScript, C++ , Java, HTML/CSS, MATLAB, Processing, Max/MSP

ML & Vision: PyTorch, scikit-learn, CLIP, SentenceTransformers, ResNet50, OpenCV, UMAP, LLM APIs, prompt design

Data & Systems: Vector search, Flask, Express, Node.js, React 18, Docker, Git

HCI Research: study design, IRB/ethics, interviews, thematic analysis, usability testing, accessibility

Tangible Interfaces: embedded systems, sensors & actuators, soft robotics

Fabrication: mechanical design, CAD: Rhino, SolidWorks, Fusion 360, digital fabrication, flow/pressure & tensile testing

Design: interaction design, rapid prototyping, Figma, Adobe CC

References

Björn Hartmann, Associate Professor, Electrical Engineering and Computer Science, UC Berkeley, bjoern@eecs.berkeley.edu

Dor Abrahamson, Professor, Cognition and Learning Sciences, School of Education, UC Berkeley, dor@berkeley.edu

Lining Yao, Assistant Professor, Mechanical Engineering; Zheng-White Faculty Fellow, UC Berkeley, liningy@berkeley.edu